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Transcripción de audio

IELTS Academic · Set 12

01 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 1: Consulta sobre estacionamiento y tarjeta de transporte

Agent: Good morning, City Transport Office. How can I help?

Customer: Hello. I've just moved to the area and I'd like to ask about a parking permit and a travel card.

Agent: Of course. Let me take a few details first. Your name?

Customer: It's Daniel Foster.

Agent: Could you spell your surname?

Customer: Yes - F-O-S-T-E-R.

Agent: Thank you. And your address?

Customer: 8 Ashgrove Avenue - that's A-S-H-G-R-O-V-E.

Agent: Thank you. Is that a house or a flat? We ask because permits for shared buildings sometimes need a bay number as well.

Customer: It is flat three, but each resident has a separate tenancy agreement. There is no allocated bay at the building itself.

Agent: That's fine. Your agreement can be used as evidence that you live within the permit zone. Have you already changed the address on your vehicle registration?

Customer: I sent the form last week, although the replacement document has not arrived yet.

Agent: Bring the old document and your tenancy agreement, and we can begin the application while you wait for the update.

Agent: Ashgrove Avenue. And the postcode?

Customer: It's NG2 6BX.

Agent: And a phone number?

Customer: My mobile's 079 3358 4162.

Agent: Great. Now, the parking permit - which car park did you want?

Customer: The riverside one, please. Oh, sorry - no, I meant the station car park. That's the one nearest my flat.

Agent: Good correction. The riverside site uses a different permit and is mainly intended for people working near the market. The site you have chosen is covered by the residential scheme, and permit holders may use any unnumbered bay there.

Customer: Does having a permit guarantee a space?

Agent: No, it gives permission to park but does not reserve a particular place. It is busiest between eight and nine on weekday mornings. After commuters leave, residents usually find spaces easily.

Agent: The station car park, fine. Just so you know, a warden checks the permits every day, so you'll need to display it clearly - on the windscreen, please, not on the dashboard.

Customer: On the windscreen. Got it.

Agent: Place it in the lower left corner where the printed date can be read from outside. If you change vehicles, do not move the old permit yourself because its number is linked to the registration. Call us and we will issue a replacement. Temporary permits for visitors are available online in books of ten.

Customer: That's useful. My parents occasionally stay for a weekend.

Agent: A visitor permit lasts until midnight on the date written on it. It cannot be reused, so complete it only when the guest has arrived.

Agent: Now, the travel card. It's very useful - you can use it on the buses and the tram, right across the city.

Customer: That's exactly what I need. What do I have to do to apply?

Agent: When you come in, just bring a recent photo of yourself and we'll print the card while you wait.

Agent: The image should show your face clearly against a plain background. It need not be professionally taken, but a picture copied from an identity document is often too small. The card is personal, so another person cannot travel with it even if you are not using it that week.

Customer: Can I add money through an app?

Agent: Yes. You can also set it to renew automatically, but that feature is optional. If the card is lost, report it through your account and the remaining balance can be transferred to a replacement.

Customer: Lovely. And how much do they cost?

Agent: We have two options. The weekly card is £15, and it includes a free map of the network. The monthly card lasts thirty days and costs £58; with that one you also get discounts at a number of shops and cafés in the centre.

Customer: Does the cheaper option begin on a Monday?

Agent: No, it runs for seven consecutive days from the first journey, so you can activate it whenever you choose. The printed guide shows the main routes and late services. The longer option begins on the date you select at purchase, and the reduced prices at participating businesses are listed in your online account.

Customer: I will be travelling to work at least five days a week, so the longer period should save me money.

Agent: It should. Keep the purchase receipt until you have successfully created your account. If the card fails at a gate, show it to the driver rather than repeatedly touching it against the reader.

Customer: I'll go for the monthly, I think.

Agent: Good choice. If you bring your photo and the £58 to the office, we can sort it out today.

Customer: Perfect, thank you very much.

02 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 2: Charla sobre una jornada de puertas abiertas en una granja

Hello everyone, and a warm welcome to Greenfields Farm on our annual open day. It's wonderful to see so many families here. Let me start by telling you what's new. This year, for the very first time, we've opened a farm shop selling our own produce, and we've built a large children's play barn for when the weather turns. Now, some of our old favourites are still here too - the café has been serving visitors for over twenty years, the duck pond is where it's always been, and yes, the tractor rides are running as usual, so don't worry. The distinction between new and returning attractions has caused some confusion on social media. The place selling produce occupies a converted machinery shed and stocks vegetables, eggs and preserves from neighbouring farms as well as our own.

The indoor activity building was completed in spring and gives younger visitors somewhere dry to climb and explore. We repainted the refreshment area and repaired the pond path, but neither of those counts as a new attraction. The vehicle tour follows the same route it used last season. Admission covers every scheduled demonstration. Purchases, refreshments and produce picked to take home are charged separately. Wristbands allow you to leave and re-enter during the event. Right, let me run through today's programme. All of our guided walks set off from the car park, just behind you, so please gather there. The meeting point is beside the blue information flag rather than at this reception area. The morning route explores the kitchen garden, while the afternoon route goes farther across the grazing land.

Both take roughly forty-five minutes. The ground can be uneven, so closed shoes are recommended, and a shorter accessible route may be requested from the guide. If a group is full, collect a ticket for the next departure instead of following at a distance. That keeps gates closed and allows the guide to answer questions safely. One thing you mustn't miss is the sheepdog display. That begins at 11, over in the top field, and it lasts about half an hour. Please reach the viewing rope a few minutes before the demonstration starts. The handler first explains the whistle commands and then shows how one animal can separate a small group of sheep from the flock. There is a second performance in mid-afternoon, but it may be shortened if the temperature rises.

Spectators should remain quiet while the animals are working. Afterwards, the handler will answer questions near the gate. Do not enter the working area, even when the flock appears calm. After that, children are welcome to help feed the lambs in the small animal barn - they do love a bottle of milk. Next to that is the dairy. Through the window, you can watch our staff making cheese in the traditional way, and there are samples to try. Feeding sessions take place every hour, and a member of staff hands out the bottles. Children must stay behind the low barrier until invited forward. In the dairy demonstration, the maker explains how the milk is warmed, separated and pressed. Samples are offered only after the talk so that visitors do not miss the safety instructions.

Anyone with a food allergy should ask to see the ingredient card. The tasting pieces are made from pasteurised milk, while one mature variety displayed behind the glass is not offered to children. If you'd like to take something home, head down to the lower field, where you can pick your own

strawberries - bring a basket if you have one. When you get hungry, hot food and drinks are served all day in the food tent, near the main gate. A couple of reminders. We do have animals roaming freely, so please keep your dogs on a lead at all times. And do watch your children near the machinery. The farm closes at 5 pm today, and the car park closes shortly after, so do allow yourself plenty of time. The fruit area stops admitting pickers half an hour before closing so that purchases can be weighed.

Meals are available throughout the event, but the kitchen takes its last hot order at four fifteen. Water points are located beside the eating area and the activity building. For safety, animals brought by visitors must remain restrained, including in open spaces. Farm vehicles have priority on marked tracks, and adults should supervise children near gates as well as equipment. At the end of the day, announcements will direct each section towards the exit in turn to reduce congestion. Above all, enjoy your day - and please do ask any of our staff in green jackets if you need help. Thank you.

03 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 3: Proyecto grupal de robótica

Tutor: So, Sam, Priya - how's the robotics project coming along? Remind me what your robot has to do.

Sam: Well, the brief is to build a small robot that can find its way through a maze without any human control.

Tutor: A maze-solving robot, good. And it has to be fully autonomous?

Priya: Yes, completely. Once we press start, it has to make all its own decisions.

Sam: The competition course contains several dead ends, so following one wall is not enough. The machine must recognise that a route has failed, return to the previous junction and choose another direction. We are not building an arm for carrying objects, and voice control is outside the brief.

Tutor: Good. That makes the aim unambiguous. How will you judge success?

Priya: First by whether it reaches the exit without intervention, and then by the time taken. Reliability matters more than one exceptionally fast run, so we plan to compare five attempts.

Tutor: Excellent. So where are you up to?

Sam: We've built the frame and fitted the wheels. The main headache has been the sensors. At first we used a camera to detect the walls, but it was far too slow to process the images.

Tutor: So what did you switch to?

Priya: We replaced it with an ultrasonic sensor, which measures distance using sound. It's much faster and, honestly, a lot cheaper as well.

Sam: The camera itself was within our budget and did not add much weight. The problem appeared when the processor analysed every frame. By the time it identified an obstacle, the front wheel had already reached it. Reducing image quality helped slightly but made corners difficult to recognise.

Tutor: So processing speed, rather than purchase price or mass, made the visual approach unsuitable.

Priya: Exactly. The new device returns a simple distance value almost instantly. We have mounted three of them so the machine can compare the front and both sides.

Tutor: A sensible choice. Now, how have you divided the work?

Sam: Priya is doing all the programming, and I'm concentrating on the electronics - the wiring and the motors.

Priya: We discuss the overall logic together, but I write and document the software. Sam selects the components, connects them and checks that the motors receive a stable voltage. That division suits our experience.

Sam: We initially thought one of us should write the entire report, but sharing it makes more sense. I can describe the circuit and Priya can explain the algorithm. We will edit the final version together so it does not read like two unrelated documents.

Tutor: Good. Keep a common record of decisions now; it will save time when you justify changes later.

Tutor: And who's writing up the report?

Priya: We're sharing that. But actually, we wondered if you could help us with the testing schedule.

Tutor: Of course. My advice would be to test the robot in a simple maze first, before you try the full competition layout. You'll find the faults much more quickly.

Tutor: Begin with straight corridors and a single turn. Once those runs are consistent, add a dead end, then several choices. Going directly to the competition course may look efficient, but when a run fails you will not know whether the cause is sensing, steering or route selection. Another team can observe later, after you have isolated the basic faults yourselves.

Priya: We can build the small course from movable boards and change one feature at a time.

Tutor: Exactly. Record the layout used for every run, otherwise the times will not be comparable.

Sam: That's a good point.

Tutor: One concern - what are you making the body from? It looks rather heavy.

Sam: It's plywood at the moment.

Tutor: I'd switch to plastic. It's lighter, and your battery will last longer.

Tutor: A larger shell would only add mass, and fitting another power pack would treat the symptom rather than the cause. A thin plastic panel should protect the circuit while reducing the load on the motors. Make sure it is stiff enough around the sensor mounts, since vibration there could produce inconsistent readings.

Sam: We can keep the plywood base temporarily as a drilling template, then transfer the positions to the new panel.

Tutor: That is sensible. Weigh both versions and include the comparison in your evaluation.

Priya: We'll change that.

Tutor: Right, a few things before next week. First, order the plastic for the new body. Then finish the code so the robot can turn corners. After that, run a full test and record the results in a table. Also, book the workshop for Friday - you'll need the space. And email me your budget, because I think you can still claim some funding.

Sam: Brilliant. Thanks so much.

Tutor: Send a short progress note with the cost document. I need to see what has already been purchased and what remains, since funding cannot be claimed twice for the same component. In Friday's session, allow time to inspect the wiring before you run the machine at full speed.

Priya: We'll bring the earlier results as well, so we can show whether the changes improve consistency.

Tutor: Good. If a run fails, record the point of failure before resetting anything. A useful evaluation explains the pattern, not merely the fastest result.

04 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 4: Visión humana del color

Good afternoon. Today we're going to explore how human beings see colour - a process that is far more remarkable than most people assume. It begins in the eye. When light enters, it is focused onto a thin layer of light-sensitive tissue at the back of the eye called the retina. This layer is packed with millions of specialised cells that convert light into electrical signals. Before those signals are created, the lens changes shape to focus an image and the pupil controls how much illumination enters. Those structures are important, but the first stage of colour coding occurs in the sensitive layer itself.

Its cells are not distributed evenly: the central region used for detailed vision has a particularly dense concentration, while the edge of our vision is better at detecting movement than fine colour differences. The electrical messages leave through the optic nerve. At the point where that nerve exits there are no receptor cells, creating a small blind spot that the visual system usually hides from our awareness. There are two main kinds of these cells. The first, called rods, are extremely sensitive and allow us to see in dim light, but they cannot detect colour. The second kind, the cones, are responsible for colour vision, though they need bright light to work well. That is why, on a dark night, the world appears in shades of grey.

Rods respond to very low levels of illumination and are numerous away from the centre of vision. If you look slightly to one side of a faint star, for instance, it may become easier to detect. Cones provide sharper detail as well as hue, but their lower sensitivity means that the distinction between objects can remain while their colours fade at dusk. Moving suddenly from a bright room into darkness demonstrates the difference. Vision is poor at first, then improves over several minutes as chemical pigments recover and the more sensitive system becomes dominant. Now, in the human eye there are three different types of cone. Each type contains a slightly different pigment, and because of this, each responds most strongly to a particular wavelength of light.

Broadly speaking, one type is most sensitive to red, another to green, and the third to blue. Every colour we perceive is produced by the eye comparing the signals from these three types, and that comparison is carried out by the brain, which interprets the mixture as a single colour. The labels red, green and blue are convenient simplifications. Each receptor responds across a broad, overlapping range, with a peak at one region rather than an exclusive response to a single hue. A yellow surface, for example, does not require a separate yellow receptor. It produces a particular balance in the first two channels, and the visual system interprets that pattern. Context alters the final perception.

The same patch can appear lighter or darker depending on its surroundings because the visual system compares neighbouring areas. This helps us recognise an object under changing illumination, although it also creates familiar optical illusions. This system also explains colour blindness. In most cases the condition is inherited, passed down from a person's parents through their genes. Interestingly, it is far more common in men than in women, for reasons linked to the way the relevant genes are carried. The most frequent form is an inability to distinguish red from green, which can make everyday tasks, such as reading a map, surprisingly difficult. The term

colour blindness can be misleading because most affected people do see many hues; particular ranges are simply difficult to separate.

Severity varies according to whether a pigment is absent or responds differently. A clinical test therefore uses patterns of coloured dots rather than asking someone to name a single sample. Good design does not rely on hue alone. A transport map can combine colour with line style, labels and symbols, while warning lights can differ in position or shape. These choices benefit people with reduced discrimination without changing the information available to other users. Finally, it's worth remembering that human vision is not the limit of what's possible. Many animals see the world quite differently. Birds, for example, have an extra type of cone and can see ultraviolet light, which is completely invisible to us.

That additional sensitivity may help a bird identify food, select a mate or follow markings on feathers that humans cannot perceive. Other species use different solutions. Many nocturnal mammals prioritise sensitivity over a broad range of hues, and some insects detect patterns on flowers beyond human vision. Comparing species reminds us that visible colour is not a fixed property copied directly from the environment. It is an interpretation produced from the receptors and neural processing available to a particular animal. Instruments can measure wavelengths outside our range, but measurement is different from experiencing the appearance those wavelengths might create for another species. Next week, we'll look at how the brain processes all these signals in more detail.